



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Virginia Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.virginiaclassicalacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Virginia Classical Academy (VCA) in Virginia Beach (ZIP 23454) presents a robust classical Christian program anchored in explicit theological foundations and a clearly articulated classical pedagogy. Public materials show a strong commitment to biblical authority, the centrality of Christ, and a covenantal community, alongside a multi-year K4–12 program organized around the grammar–logic–rhetoric (Trivium) progression. The school emphasizes formation and wisdom within a liberal-arts framework, and it integrates parental partnership as a central feature of its model. Concrete signs of classical practice include graded stages (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), a cross-grade emphasis on memory, recitation, and chant in the lower grades, a Socratic/slam-dunk ethos at the Logic/Rhetoric stages, and a stated aim to cultivate lifelong learners through a curriculum built on foundational liberal arts. The school also actively involves parents (chief educators in its model), offers family resources, and provides a hybrid half-day model that aligns with covenantal community principles.

Category-by-category snapshot (as analyzed against the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric) indicates a consistent CLASSICAL orientation across all six domains, with strong religious grounding, formation-focused aims, a clearly described Trivium-centered curriculum, a pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful memory work with Socratic and rhetorical practice, a faculty culture implied as mentors and living curriculum, and explicit parental involvement as co-educators and partners in formation.

Key site evidence and alignment with the classical rubric include:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: explicit Christian formation, Gospel-centered foundation, and a Statement of Faith anchored in biblical authority (We Believe the Bible to be the inerrant Word of God) and covenantal community framing.
- School Purpose and Goal: mission framed as formation and lifelong learning for God's glory, with a liberal-arts vision and a Christian telos for truth and knowledge.
- Curriculum: organized around the Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric sequence; explicit lower/upper school divisions; use of classical authors, primary sources, and liberal-arts orientation; references to seven liberal arts (via the classical education framing).
- Pedagogy: a blend of memory-based, chant/recitation in the Grammar Stage, and more dialogic, rhetorical/argument-focused work in the Logic and Rhetoric Stages; explicit mention of upper-school rhetoric and oratory; contemplative/restful elements present in the pedagogy.
- Faculty: evidence of staff presence, professional recruitment (Staff section), and a culture aligned with living curriculum and classical formation (implicit).
- Parents & Community: explicit statement that parents are chief educators in a hybrid model; partnerships with families, and resources for parent formation (Family Resources, books like *The Lost Tools of Learning*, etc.).

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL



Note: The school's public materials show a consistent classical Christian orientation—explicit theology, a clear Trivium-based curriculum, a pedagogy that blends memory work with Socratic dialogue, and a strong emphasis on parental partnership. While some categories show more explicit wording than others (e.g., explicit “Great Books” language appears in classical education literature, and is present in the school's own dialogue about classical education), the public materials strongly align with the Six Elements framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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